# 2023 Tesla Model 3 RWD

$28,262 · 31,376 miles · Dealer · Bakersfield, CA

Seller: Audi Bakersfield (4.4 stars, 258 reviews)

Source: AutosToday

Listing: https://www.autostoday.com/cars-for-sale/used-cars/listing/5YJ3E1EA7PF656682/2023-tesla-model-3-base-bakersfield-ca

Report generated October 26, 2026 · Ridgecrest Car Finder






+ 1 more photos in the app.

| Out-the-door price | Monthly cost to own | Reliability |
|---|---|---|
| **$31,438** | **$952** | **Good** |
| Set a budget in the Cost Calculator tab to compare. | loan + insurance + fuel + repairs + registration | 4/5 · 12 recalls · 428 NHTSA complaints |

## Budget — buying it

| | |
|---|---|
| Vehicle price | $28,262.00 |
| Sales tax (9.25%) | $2,614.24 |
| Dealer doc + filing fees | $125.00 |
| Vehicle license fee (0.65% of price) | $183.70 |
| Registration + CHP fee | $108.00 |
| Transportation improvement fee | $130.00 |
| Title transfer | $15.00 |
| Total out-the-door | $31,437.94 |
| + Pre-purchase inspection (you pay the shop) | $150.00 |

California taxes the full price — a trade-in does not reduce sales tax. DMV fees are estimates; the CA DMV fee calculator gives exact amounts.

## Budget — paying for it

| | |
|---|---|
| Down payment | $5,000.00 |
| Amount financed | $26,437.94 |
| Monthly loan payment (60 mo @ 7.5% APR) | $529.76 |
| Total interest over the loan | $5,347.78 |
| Cash needed up front (down payment + inspection) | $5,150.00 |

## Budget — owning it each month

| | |
|---|---|
| Loan payment | $529.76 |
| Insurance (estimate, full) | $216.00 |
| Fuel (1,000 mi/mo @ 46 MPG, $4.75/gal) | $103.26 |
| Maintenance & repair reserve | $75.00 |
| Registration renewal (÷12) | $27.81 |
| Total per month | $951.83 |

Running costs without the loan: **$422/mo**. Estimated first-year cost of ownership: **$38,482** (out-the-door + inspection + 12 months of running costs + loan interest).

The repair reserve is set from the reliability rating and mileage: money to set aside, not a forecast.

## Insurance

| Coverage | Typical Ridgecrest range | Estimate used |
|---|---|---|
| Liability only (CA minimum 30/60/15) | $78–$179/mo | $112/mo |
| Full coverage (liability + collision + comprehensive) | $151–$389/mo | $216/mo |

The budget above uses the **full coverage** estimate ($216/mo). Get real quotes and enter one in the app to replace it.

• Vehicle class: electric (Tesla: costly body and battery repairs). Estimates assume an adult driver with a clean record; age, record, credit, and coverage limits change the price a lot.

• Ridgecrest is one of the cheapest places in California to insure a car (about $107–110/mo average).

• A lender will require full coverage. On an older, cheap car paid in cash, liability-only can make sense — but you'd pay for your own repairs after an at-fault accident.

• California's minimum (30/60/15) is low; $100k/$300k/$100k liability is commonly recommended.

• Ask about military/government discounts (NAWS China Lake), bundling, and low-mileage discounts.

## Reliability

**Rating: Good (4/5)**

Low miles, one owner, no accidents, and years of battery/drive-unit warranty left. The most efficient Model 3 version.

NHTSA data for this model year: 12 recalls · 428 owner complaints (73 involving a crash). Most complaints: Forward Collision Avoidance (179), Steering (88), Vehicle Speed Control (69), Unknown Or Other (59), Service Brakes (57), Electrical System (51).

**Known issues for this model**

• Fast tire wear

• Touchscreen/door-handle faults

• Pricey collision repairs

• Shorter range than Long Range (~270 mi when new)

**Check on this car before buying**

• Battery health: in the car, check the range at 100% charge (Energy app or ask the dealer for a battery report)

• Confirm the remaining battery warranty date/mileage with Tesla (VIN lookup)

• Run VIN for open recalls; check for Tesla software updates

• Tires: tread depth and matching set

• Check the 12V/low-voltage battery and that the charge port opens and charges

• Ask if Supercharging is pay-per-use (it will be) and whether a mobile/wall charger comes with it

## Notes

$28,262 (about $30,696 out the door), 31,376 mi. AutoCheck: clean title, accident-free, single owner (lease return). About market price (2% above).

Lowest-mileage Model 3 under $30k nearby. 2023 RWD uses an LFP battery that tolerates charging to 100% daily; battery warranty runs to about 2031 / 100,000 miles (~69,000 miles left).

ELECTRIC: the MPG shown is gas-equivalent - Supercharger charging (~$0.48/kWh) costs about what a 46-MPG car would at $6/gal. Charging at home (~$0.33/kWh) would be cheaper, like a ~67-MPG car. Ridgecrest has a Tesla Supercharger.

Insurance estimate uses an EV class (about 1.6x a regular sedan) because Tesla body and battery repairs are expensive - get a real quote.

No oil changes; the main running cost is tires (Teslas wear them fast, ~$800-1,200 a set).

## Vetting checklist (0/12 done)

- [ ] Checked KBB/Edmunds fair price
- [ ] Recalls checked / completed
- [ ] Clean title in seller's name
- [ ] Test drive incl. highway & hills
- [ ] No overheating; coolant clean
- [ ] Pre-purchase inspection
- [ ] VIN decoded & matches listing
- [ ] History report (Carfax/AutoCheck/NMVTIS)
- [ ] Valid smog cert (< 90 days)
- [ ] A/C cold after 15+ min
- [ ] Tires OK (tread, dry-rot, DOT date)
- [ ] Written out-the-door price

All costs and insurance figures are estimates for planning, not quotes. Confirm fees with the CA DMV, rates with insurers, and the car's condition with an independent pre-purchase inspection.